YOU CAN'T BE WHAT YOU DON'T SEE





Cindy Slaven

Chief Business Development, Marketing and Communications Officer for Navantia Australia

They say "You can't be what you don't see". In defence industry, it can be difficult to see women, particularly in positions of leadership as it's a male dominated environment.

My name is Cindy Slaven and I am the Chief Business Development, Marketing and Communications Officer for Navantia Australia. I am proud of what I have achieved in my career with Navantia Australia and grateful for the opportunities that have been made available to me by the company.

At Navantia Australia, I feel equal despite being part of a minority group. As the only female member of the Australian senior leadership team at this point in time, I feel my seat at the table is recognition of the contribution I have made to the company, my abilities and not an example of tokenism. This is important. When an industry is underrepresented in its gender diversity, it can be an easy mistake for organisations to set quotas in an attempt to re-address this.

I believe it is vital that we as women, are not only seen but also heard in our industry. It is important to highlight women, to recognize their achievements, and acknowledge those who are making positive impact. This serves to show each of us, and the men we work with, that it is possible and enables us to learn from others' experiences. I have been fortunate to have been nominated by my colleagues for industry wide awards and further to have been recognized by my peers as a finalist in the same.

Integral to the culture we have at Navantia Australia is ensuring that it is an inclusive company and celebrate diversity. We try to do this through initiatives, support programs and policies.

As women we face different challenges to our male counterparts. These are typically evident in leadership and management styles and pay disparity. In an industry such as ours, where women are in the minority, puts us at a disadvantage, so growing the confidence, the styles and the understanding of these differences benefits everyone in addressing this imbalance.

In recognition of the challenges that exist for women, we believe that it helps to offer a forum that builds a little sisterly solidarity. "For the WIN (Women In Navantia)" is an initiative that is the brainchild of one of our female employees that has been embraced by the company. For the WIN encourages women in Navantia Australia to come together to increase their sense of social connection and establish a supportive community amongst ourselves to discuss these challenges.

This year we have funded high performing women to participate in an award winning defence industry womens' mentoring program. This program is specifically aimed at addressing diversity head on by supporting the development of women within engineering and project management. I look forward to seeing these women develop throughout their career and progress to holding leadership positions in their fields.

We have also considered unique needs that support women returning to work and balancing their parenting responsibilities through introducing wellness rooms. Other policies such as generous parental leave entitlements and flexible working arrangements also support women who want to continue their careers after starting families by making it easier for their partners to support them and balance childcare.



Jose Porto

Navantia India Managing Director

Navantia is a Spanish Government owned company, and one of the world leaders in Shipbuilding industry. Navantia has offices and companies all over the world to support its customers and participate in the most advance and complex programs in the Defence market.

Over the years, Navantia has put in place policies and initiates to uplift and empower the women across the company, increasing the number, success, and satisfaction of the women at the company. Obviously, the work is not done, we do believe that this is a work that must be done in a daily basis, being embedded in our company culture.

Navantia established a liaison office in India on the 23rd of November 2015 to participate in the P75I and LPD tenders. We are confident that our proposals will satisfy the Indian Navy needs, and if that happens, Navantia´s aim is to establish a company in India that supports women´s leadership as it´s being done not only in Navantia Spain but also in the rest of the organization like Navantia Australia